

## Mission 004 Backend Handoff

### Completed

- Mission 004 is defined as the live-truth ingestion mission
- The backend must keep the timeline API read-only and production-safe
- The backend must point at a canonical production live source for the final release
- The backend must also ingest updates into that source so the displayed truth stays current
- The safest practical ingestion path now supported in code is polling a configured HTTPS JSON endpoint via ``AGENTS_VIS_DASHBOARD_SOURCE_URL``
- The repo-backed live source snapshot now includes Mission 004 as the latest mission
- The code path for remote source polling is already implemented and covered by tests
- Production now reads the canonical live source and surfaces Mission 004 with explicit stale freshness

### Current backend behavior target

- Keep ``GET /api/missions/latest`` stable
- Keep latest-mission-only selection
- Keep chronological ordering
- Keep parallel metadata intact
- Keep freshness / stale / lag fields intact
- Keep cache behavior predictable in production
- Keep ingestion safe, explicit, and resumable
- Document each backend step in a PDF artifact stored in the repo at ``docs/missions/pdfs/``
- This run revalidated the backend locally with the full repo test suite, typecheck, and build, then the live deployment picked up the Mission 004 snapshot

### Production source target

- The final release should not depend on a frozen snapshot
- The production live source must be explicit and verifiable
- If no canonical production source exists yet, that is the first backend blocker to solve
- The team should prefer polling a remote JSON endpoint over webhook when the source can expose JSON directly
- Webhook is not required
- Production is now reading Mission 004 data from the canonical live source, and stale freshness remains visible by design

### Next backend step

Keep the ingestion path and source shape stable while preserving visible stale/lag semantics in production.

### Live production note

- The deployed app is serving the Mission 004 snapshot and stale freshness data
- Production smoke this run confirmed ``GET /api/missions/latest`` is Mission 004 and ``GET /api/dashboard`` still reports stale freshness